Morgan Stanley | RESEARCH

UPDATE

November 4, 2026 01:27 AM GMT

Cricut Inc | North America

3Q26 Earnings Quick Take – A Better Quarter

AlphaSignals Earnings Reaction

Unchanged	Modest upside	Modest revision higher
Impact to our thesis	Financial results versus consensus	Direction of next 12-month consensus EPS

Source: Company data, Morgan Stanley Research

3Q was an encouraging step forward as Products returned to growth, machine sell-out rose double digits, and engagement remains stable. Still, channel fill and easier compares helped revenue, while inventory-related benefits supported margins. Sustainability remains the key question from here.

Key Takeaways

- 3Q revenue and EPS beat MSe, supported by a robust Products rebound and stronger gross margins.
- Double-digit machine sell-out growth Y/Y for a second straight quarter is encouraging, though channel fill and easier compares also helped growth.
- Mgmt remains cautious on the 4Q consumer despite positive early sell-out trends and expectations for sequential Products growth.
- Active user growth and engagement stabilization are positive, but Platform growth and subscriber additions remain modest.
- Strong 3Q margins benefited from volume growth, inventory-related timing, excess inventory monetization, and final tariff refunds.

A better quarter, but questions remain on sustainability. This quarter was a positive step forward, but sustainability remains the key question. Revenue grew 11% Y/Y to $189M, 9-10% ahead of MSe/Consensus, with Products inflecting to positive growth (+17% Y/Y) from -22% Y/Y in 2Q and Platform up 4% Y/Y. EPS of $0.13 also came in ahead of expectations (MS at $0.03 and Street at $0.05), aided by stronger gross margins, particularly on the Product side. More encouraging, in our view, was a second consecutive quarter of double-digit connected machine sell-out growth, alongside improving active user trends and continued stabilization in engagement. Additionally, CRCT announced a $0.70/share special dividend and replenished its share repurchase authorization to $50M, supported by continued cash generation. Mgmt now expects full-year revenue growth for the first time since 2021, an encouraging milestone and an important step in the right direction. That said, channel fill ahead of new product launches and easier Y/Y compares contributed to Product growth, while inventory-related timing benefits, excess inventory monetization, and the final IEEPA tariff refunds also supported profitability. With mgmt remaining cautious on the consumer heading into 4Q, Platform growth still

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Cricut Inc (CRCT.O, CRCT US)

IT Hardware | United States of America

Stock Rating	**Underweight**
Industry View	**In-Line**
Price target	**$3.70**
Shr price, close (Nov 3, 2026)	$5.97
Mkt cap, curr (mm)	$1,259
52-Week Range	$6.82-3.74

Fiscal Year Ending	12/25	12/26e	12/27e	12/28e
EPS ($)**	0.36	0.32	0.22	0.25
Prior EPS ($)**	-	-	-	-
P/E	13.8	18.4	27.1	24.3
EPS ($)§	0.35	0.35	0.24	0.26
Div yld (%)	19.2	3.4	3.4	3.4

Unless otherwise noted, all metrics are based on Morgan Stanley ModelWare framework
** = Based on consensus methodology
§ = Consensus data is provided by Refinitiv Estimates
e = Morgan Stanley Research estimates

QUARTERLY EPS ($)

Quarter	2025	2026e Prior	2026e Current	2027e Prior	2027e Current
Q1	0.11	-	0.10a	-	0.07
Q2	0.11	-	0.19a	-	0.07
Q3	0.10	-	0.03	-	0.06
Q4	0.04	-	0.01	-	0.02

e = Morgan Stanley Research estimates, a = Actual Company reported data

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relatively modest, and Accessories & Materials competition persisting, we think the sustainability of the recovery remains to be proven. *Our forward estimates and price target are under review following the quarter, though we share 3 key observations following the quarter:*

- **New products are helping drive a Products rebound**. Products revenue grew 17% Y/Y to $103M, a sharp improvement from -22% in 2Q, supported by the launch of Maker 5 and, to a smaller extent given the late September launch, the new StickerPix product category. More importantly, connected machine sell-out units grew double digits for the second consecutive quarter, suggesting that improving consumer demand extends beyond retailer orders. However, mgmt acknowledged that 3Q revenue benefited from channel fill ahead of new product launches and easier Y/Y comparisons following last year's tariff-related revenue pull-forward, making it difficult to isolate the underlying growth contribution. Looking to 4Q, mgmt remains cautious on the consumer, although early sell-out trends have been positive and Products revenue is expected to grow Q/Q and Y/Y. While we are encouraged by the momentum, more consistent sell-out strength will be needed to indicate whether we're seeing a more durable demand inflection.
- **Engagement stabilization continues, but Platform growth has yet to meaningfully accelerate.** Active users grew 2% Y/Y, while 90-day engaged users remained flat Y/Y for the second consecutive quarter. Meanwhile, Platform revenue grew 4% Y/Y, supported by 3% ARPU growth and a 2% increase in paid subscribers, although subscribers declined ~1% sequentially, in-line with normal seasonality. Mgmt remains focused on improving onboarding, expanding premium subscription tiers internationally, and adding AI-powered tools and content to drive engagement and monetization. Higher-priced subscription offerings are gaining traction, but mgmt also acknowledged that higher prices can weigh on sign-up rates, suggesting elasticity surrounding ARPU growth and subscriber additions. While engagement stabilization and the opportunity to drive further monetization through pricing is encouraging, stronger subscriber growth and improved aftermarket spending are the next items we're looking out for.
- **A few moving pieces behind 3Q margin strength**. Gross margins expanded 250bps Y/Y to 57.7%, with Products gross margins improving to 30.8% from 23.1% last year, helping drive a 50% Y/Y increase in operating income. Mgmt attributed the improvement to higher Products volumes, monetization of excess and obsolete inventory, and the final IEEPA tariff refunds. Mgmt also clarified that the inventory build ahead of new launches benefited margins through the capitalization of procurement costs, which will flow through as inventory is sold. While the improvement in profitability is encouraging, the mix of one-time benefits and inventory-related timing dynamics makes it difficult to assess how much of the underlying margin improvement is sustainable. Looking to 4Q, the setup is more challenging given higher promos (typical holiday quarter seasonality), pressure from the reversal of these inventory-related benefits, while tariff refunds are not expected to repeat. For the longer term, mgmt reiterated that the FY24 Product GM (~19%) remains a reasonable reference point.

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Earnings Variance

Exhibit 1: Cricut (CRCT) 3Q26 Earnings Variance

Cricut Earnings Analysis

Ticker: **CRCT**
Industry View: **In-Line**
Rating: **Underweight**

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4Q26 and CY26 Expectations
Consensus estimates (pre-call): 4Q26 Revenue of $209M, EBITDA of $19M, and EPS of $0.02; CY26 Revenue of $697M, EBITDA of $119M, and EPS of $0.35.
MS estimates (pre-call): 4Q26 Revenue of $207M, EBITDA of $8M, and EPS of $0.01; CY26 Revenue of $696M, EBITDA of $102M, and EPS of $0.32.

($ Millions)	4Q24A	1Q25A	2Q25A	3Q25A	4Q25A	1Q26A	2Q26A	3Q26A	3Q26E	% Delta	Share Impact	Q/Q Chg	Y/Y Chg	Cons. Est.
Total Revenue	**209.3**	**162.6**	**172.1**	**170.4**	**203.6**	**159.5**	**156.3**	**188.6**	**173.7**	**9%**	**$ 0.03**	**21%**	**11%**	**172.0**
Y/Y Growth	*-9%*	*-3%*	*2%*	*2%*	*-3%*	*-2%*	*-9%*	*11%*	*2%*					
Q/Q Growth	*25%*	*-22%*	*6%*	*-1%*	*19%*	*-22%*	*-2%*	*21%*	*11%*					
Gross Profit	**94.0**	**98.3**	**101.5**	**94.1**	**96.4**	**92.7**	**116.4**	**108.9**	**85.6**	**27%**	**$ 0.08**	**-6%**	**16%**	
Gross Profit Margin	*44.9%*	*60.5%*	*59.0%*	*55.2%*	*47.4%*	*58.1%*	*74.5%*	*57.7%*	*49.3%*					
R&D	16.0	15.7	16.8	16.9	17.2	16.6	16.9	17.1	18.9	-10%	$ 0.01	1%	1%	
R&D as a % of Sales	*7.6%*	*9.6%*	*9.7%*	*9.9%*	*8.5%*	*10.4%*	*10.8%*	*9.1%*	*10.9%*					
S&M	41.6	36.7	35.9	37.5	49.4	36.3	38.0	41.2	44.3	-7%	$ 0.01	8%	10%	
S&M as a % of Sales	*19.9%*	*22.6%*	*20.8%*	*22.0%*	*24.3%*	*22.8%*	*24.3%*	*21.8%*	*25.5%*					
G&A	22.5	16.7	18.8	17.1	15.9	16.9	14.1	16.7	17.0	-2%	$ 0.00	18%	-2%	
G&A as a % of Sales	*10.7%*	*10.2%*	*10.9%*	*10.0%*	*7.8%*	*10.6%*	*9.0%*	*8.9%*	*9.8%*					
Total Operating Expenses	**80.1**	**69.0**	**71.4**	**71.4**	**82.5**	**69.8**	**69.0**	**75.0**	**80.3**	**-7%**		**9%**	**5%**	
EBITDA	**20.6**	**35.4**	**36.3**	**29.5**	**20.2**	**28.6**	**53.5**	**40.8**	**12.3**	**233%**		**-24%**	**38%**	**23.2**
EBITDA Margin	*9.8%*	*21.8%*	*21.1%*	*17.3%*	*9.9%*	*17.9%*	*34.3%*	*21.6%*	*7.1%*					*13.5%*
Operating Income	**13.9**	**29.3**	**30.1**	**22.7**	**13.9**	**22.9**	**47.4**	**33.9**	**5.4**	**530%**	**$ 0.10**	**-29%**	**50%**	**11.3**
Operating Margin	*6.6%*	*18.0%*	*17.5%*	*13.3%*	*6.8%*	*14.4%*	*30.3%*	*18.0%*	*3.1%*					*6.6%*
Other Income (Expense)	2.8	3.3	3.7	3.0	1.9	2.2	2.9	2.5	3.3	-25%	$ (0.00)	-14%	-17%	
Tax rate	28.3%	26.7%	27.6%	20.0%	50.7%	19.0%	22.4%	23.5%	29.0%					
Net Income	**11.9**	**23.9**	**24.5**	**20.5**	**7.8**	**20.3**	**39.1**	**27.8**	**6.2**	**351%**	**$ 0.10**	**-29%**	**36%**	
EPS	**$0.06**	**$0.11**	**$0.11**	**$0.10**	**$0.04**	**$0.10**	**$0.19**	**$0.13**	**$0.03**		**$0.10**	**-29%**	**37%**	**$0.05**
Diluted Share Count	215.0	213.8	214.5	215.3	214.7	212.5	211.1	212.8	209.0	2%				
Segment Gross Margin ($M)	**4Q24A**	**1Q25A**	**2Q25A**	**3Q25A**	**4Q25A**	**1Q26A**	**2Q26A**	**3Q26A**	**3Q26E**					
Product	**24.3**	**27.0**	**29.7**	**20.3**	**22.1**	**17.3**	**37.4**	**31.7**	**12.8**	**148%**		**-15%**	**56%**	
Product Gross Margin	*18.7%*	*32.7%*	*32.4%*	*23.1%*	*18.4%*	*23.1%*	*52.4%*	*30.8%*	*14.5%*					
Platform	**69.7**	**71.3**	**71.9**	**73.8**	**74.4**	**75.4**	**79.0**	**77.2**	**72.9**	**6%**		**-2%**	**5%**	
Platform Gross Margin	*87.9%*	*89.2%*	*89.1%*	*89.2%*	*88.6%*	*89.0%*	*93.0%*	*89.9%*	*85.0%*					
User Metrics (Thousands)	**4Q24A**	**1Q25A**	**2Q25A**	**3Q25A**	**4Q25A**	**1Q26A**	**2Q26A**	**3Q26A**	**3Q26E**					
Active Users (EoP)	**5,892**	**5,926**	**5,901**	**5,874**	**5,871**	**5,969**	**5,969**	**5,989**	**5,915**	**1.2%**		**0%**	**2%**	
Y/Y Growth	*-1%*	*0%*	*0%*	*0%*	*0%*	*1%*	*1%*	*2%*	*1%*					
Q/Q Growth	*0%*	*1%*	*0%*	*0%*	*0%*	*2%*	*0%*	*0%*	*-1%*					
Users Creating in Last 90 Days	**3,812**	**3,372**	**3,482**	**3,451**	**3,695**	**3,345**	**3,494**	**3,466**	**3,372**	**2.8%**		**-1%**	**0%**	
Y/Y Growth	*-3%*	*-4%*	*-2%*	*-2%*	*-3%*	*-1%*	*0%*	*0%*	*-1%*					
Q/Q Growth	*8%*	*-12%*	*3%*	*-1%*	*7%*	*-9%*	*4%*	*-1%*	*-4%*					
Paid Subscribers (EoP)	**2,959**	**2,974**	**3,010**	**3,004**	**3,091**	**3,078**	**3,103**	**3,072**	**3,064**	**0.3%**		**-1%**	**2%**	
Y/Y Growth	*7%*	*6%*	*7%*	*6%*	*4%*	*3%*	*3%*	*2%*	*2%*					
Q/Q Growth	*4%*	*1%*	*1%*	*0%*	*3%*	*0%*	*1%*	*-1%*	*-1%*					
Balance Sheet / Return Metrics	**4Q24A**	**1Q25A**	**2Q25A**	**3Q25A**	**4Q25A**	**1Q26A**	**2Q26A**	**3Q26A**	**3Q26E**					
CFO	103.1	61.2	36.2	20.5	82.4	26.9	50.4	23.7	28.7	-18%		**-53%**	**16%**	
FCF	**99.2**	**56.3**	**30.5**	**13.9**	**75.2**	**17.7**	**40.8**	**13.8**	**22.3**	**-38%**		**-66%**	**0%**	
Cash and Cash Equivalents	**232.1**	**252.1**	**298.1**	**187.9**	**256.2**	**236.5**	**266.9**	**174.6**	**248.8**					
Days Sales	45	40	43	48	42	38	42	51	36	43%		+	+	
Days Payable	43	82	93	82	61	77	125	118	100	18%		-	+	
Days Inventory	92	160	161	163	88	143	242	169	135	26%		-	+	
Cash Conversion	**94**	**119**	**111**	**128**	**68**	**104**	**159**	**103**	**71**	**45%**		-	-	

Source: Company data, Morgan Stanley Research. E = Morgan Stanley Research estimates.

Source: Company data, FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research estimates (E)

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Valuation Methodology and Risks

Cricut Inc (CRCT.O)

Our $3.70 price target assumes Cricut trades at a target ~17x P/E multiple on our CY27 EPS of $0.22. This gives CRCT partial credit for stronger LT growth than printing companies, but also penalizes them for NT Y/Y declines, challenged NT engagement, margin pressures and a lack of visibility.

Risks to Upside

- User engagement spikes above COVID levels
- Positive mix shift to higher margin aftermarket sales
- Cricut gains credibility sooner than expected, driving multiple expansion

Risks to Downside

- User growth slows $ net new adds declines
- Engagement metrics disappoint vs. expectations
- Cricut is unable to raise prices to mitigate tariff headwinds
- Consumer demand deteriorates from here due to increased tariff pressures

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(as of October 31, 2026)

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hold, and sell but represent recommended relative weightings (see definitions below). To satisfy regulatory requirements, we correspond Overweight, our most positive stock rating, with a buy recommendation; we correspond Equal-weight and Not-Rated to hold and Underweight to sell recommendations, respectively.

	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
Stock Rating Category	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1575	43%	460	49%	29%	742	44%
Equal-weight/Hold	1537	42%	393	42%	26%	720	43%
Not-Rated/Hold	2	0%	1	0%	50%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	570	15%	92	10%	16%	218	13%
Total	3,684		946			1681	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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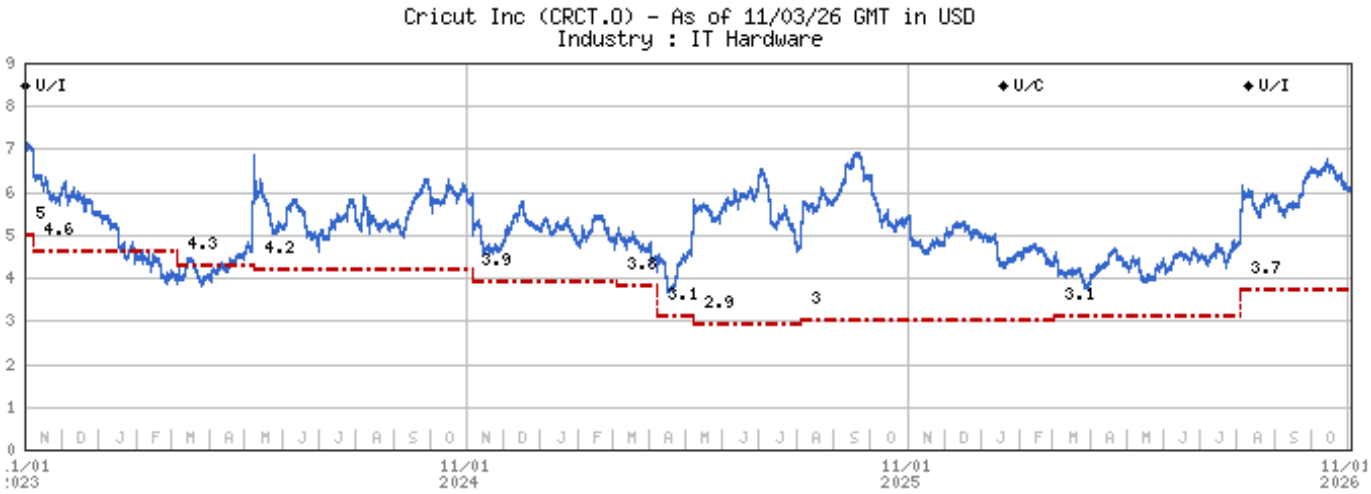
Cautious (C): The analyst views the performance of his or her industry coverage universe over the next 12-18 months with caution vs. the relevant broad market benchmark, as indicated below.

Benchmarks for each region are as follows: North America - S&P 500; Latin America - relevant MSCI country index or MSCI Latin America Index; Europe - MSCI Europe; Japan - TOPIX; Asia - relevant MSCI country index or MSCI sub-regional index or MSCI AC Asia Pacific ex Japan Index.

Stock Price, Price Target and Rating History (See Rating Definitions)

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Stock Rating History: 11/1/21 : U/C; 1/18/23 : U/I; 1/20/26 : U/C; 8/10/26 : U/I

Price Target History: 8/12/21 : 29; 11/11/21 : 20; 3/8/22 : 9; 5/16/22 : 8.7; 6/14/22 : 6; 8/9/22 : 5.7; 10/17/22 : 5; 11/7/23 : 4.6; 3/6/24 : 4.3; 5/8/24 : 4.2; 11/5/24 : 3.9; 3/5/25 : 3.8; 4/8/25 : 3.1; 5/7/25 : 2.9; 8/5/25 : 3; 3/3/26 : 3.1; 8/4/26 : 3.7

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Date Format : MM/DD/YY Price Target -·- No Price Target Assigned (NA)
Stock Price (Not Covered by Current Analyst) — Stock Price (Covered by Current Analyst) ▬
Stock and Industry Ratings (abbreviations below) appear as ◆ Stock Rating/Industry View
Stock Ratings: Overweight (O) Equal-weight (E) Underweight (U) Not-Rated (NR) No Rating Available (NA)
Industry View: Attractive (A) In-line (I) Cautious (C) No Rating (NR)

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INDUSTRY COVERAGE: IT Hardware

COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (11/03/2026)
Erik W Woodring		
Accelevation (ACCV.O)	E (10/26/2026)	$14.11
Apple, Inc. (AAPL.O)	O (05/26/2009)	$331.90
CDW Corporation (CDW.O)	O (06/23/2026)	$149.77
Cricut Inc (CRCT.O)	U (08/12/2021)	$5.97
Dell Technologies Inc. (DELL.N)	E (06/01/2026)	$408.40
Everpure, Inc. (P.N)	O (08/10/2026)	$117.65
Garmin Ltd (GRMN.N)	E (02/18/2026)	$271.44
GoPro Inc (GPRO.O)	U (12/12/2023)	$0.96
Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE.N)	O (08/10/2026)	$53.10
HP Inc. (HPQ.N)	U (11/16/2025)	$28.27
IBM (IBM.N)	E (01/18/2023)	$250.04
Ingram Micro (INGM.N)	E (06/11/2025)	$26.51
Kornit Digital Ltd. (KRNT.O)	E (11/06/2025)	$16.88
Logitech International SA (LOGI.O)	U (01/20/2026)	$92.85
NetApp Inc (NTAP.O)	E (08/10/2026)	$190.78
Resideo Technologies Inc (REZI.N)	O (08/11/2025)	$19.24
Seagate Technology (STX.O)	O (03/26/2024)	$606.38
SmartRent, Inc. (SMRT.N)	++	$1.37
Sonos Inc. (SONO.O)	E (11/06/2025)	$15.94
TD Synnex Corporation (SNX.N)	O (06/11/2025)	$228.04
Teradata (TDC.N)	E (08/10/2026)	$33.62
Western Digital (WDC.O)	O (04/16/2025)	$347.35
Sanjit K Singh		
Nutanix Inc (NTNX.O)	E (01/12/2026)	$64.68

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